Plant responses to temperature

☞ **1** Read the information below, then underline any examples of how plants respond to temperature changes.

Oranges grown in cool regions have green skin while their fruit forms in the hot summer months. In autumn when the fruit ripens, the skin colour changes to orange. This colour change is due to the cooling air temperature. Ripe oranges grown in tropical climates normally stay green-skinned because there are no cooler months.

Plants are very sensitive to temperature changes and day length. **Deciduous** trees lose their leaves in autumn when the temperature drops and days are shorter. The trees become **dormant** and their **sap** doesn't flow. In countries where snowfall is frequent this leaf-fall and dormancy protects the trees from freezing. Bulbs such as tulips flower best when they have been through a period of chilling, as if packed under snow. In Australia these conditions are rare so commercial growers 'force' tulips into flowering by refrigerating them for several months.

2 Draw deciduous trees along the timeline, showing how they change throughout a typical year.



3 List two examples of deciduous trees.

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